in the second half of the nineteenth century. But, as I have mentioned elsewhere, during the months that preceded I used to go to the beach and, in a quiet corner, read my only available French book, *Dominique*, a novel by Eugène Fromentin.

Thursday, May 4

Gantz's interview on *Ynet Radio* is worth remembering for its idea of a plea deal for Netanyahu: the indictments would be canceled, but he would leave political life. Hard to believe that Netanyahu would accept this. But the fact is that he faces crisis after crisis and is unable to govern without being confronted by stupendous demands from his coalition partners, both religious and nationalist. Today, Shas also decided to abstain from Knesset voting, because the law that would bring Deri back was put on the backburner: "We do not want to continue without Deri." Does it mean that all three coalition partners of Likud will abstain from voting?

The main demonstrations for and against the judicial overhaul took place today in front of retired Chief Justice Aharon Barak's house. Supporters of the overhaul played Moroccan music and distributed Moroccan sweets to passers-by, under the pretext that Barak was the justice who initiated the activism of the Supreme Court and who supposedly said that he did not know of any Moroccan judge who could sit on the Supreme Court. On the other side of the street stood the demonstrators who came to support Barak. The resentment of the Mizrahim that Netanyahu so cleverly utilized in the elections has spread deep and wide, and it now penetrates every crevice of Israeli life.

Three Palestinians who took part in the killing of the mother and her two daughters some weeks ago were killed today in the casbah of Nablus.

Friday, May 5